

OrchidApp

Add and Manage Plants in OrchidApp

User guide for creating plant records and using the Plant Details page

Applies to: Raspberry Pi / Linux

User guide

Use this guide after OrchidApp has been installed, opened in a browser and the first-use setup has been completed.

Purpose

This guide explains how to:

- add a plant
- understand the Plant Details page
- record day-to-day events
- add and manage photos
- record flowering
- record repotting
- move a plant between growing locations
- split a plant
- propagate a plant
- view plant heritage

Before you start

Before adding a plant:

- add the plant group, also called the genus
- add the species / hybrid before adding the plant
- add the growing locations you use
- add the growth media you use

Each plant gets a permanent **Plant Tag** automatically when it is saved.

Use events to build the plant history over time rather than keeping everything in one large note.

Typical workflow

1. Open **Plants** from the Home page or the top menu.
2. Choose **Add plant**.
3. Select the species / hybrid.
4. Enter acquisition details and save the plant.
5. Use the Plant Details page to add observations, photos, feeding, movements, flowering and repotting records.

Quick reference: Plant Details actions

Action	Use it for	Result
Add observation	General notes or quick observations, including photo observations.	Adds an observation card to the plant history.
Move plant	Recording that the plant has moved to a new growing location.	Updates the current location and keeps previous locations in history.
Add flowering	Recording a flowering period, spike count, flower count and notes.	Adds flowering to history and updates the summary on the Plant Details page.
Add repotting	Recording potting medium, root condition, pot size and reason for repotting.	Adds repotting to history and updates the repotting summary.
Split plant	Ending one plant and creating two or more new independent plants.	The parent becomes ended/read-only. Child plants receive new permanent Plant Tags.
Propagate plant	Creating a new plant while keeping the existing plant alive.	Creates a new plant linked to the original plant as provenance.
Tap image	Opening the plant photo page.	Lets you browse photos, upload more and set the main image.

1. Open Plants

You can open **Plants** from either the Home page or the top menu.

Both take you to the same place.

OrchidApp Home Plants Reports Setup About/Help

Search by tag

Find

Plants

View and manage your collection

Select a species / hybrid to view its plants.

Add plant

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On the Plants page, choose **Add plant** to create a new plant record.

2. Add a plant

Select the species / hybrid

OrchidApp first asks which species / hybrid the new plant belongs to.

This is why the species / hybrid should already exist before adding a plant.

OrchidApp Home Plants Reports Setup About/Help

Add plant

Select the genus and species / hybrid

Choose the botanical name for the new plant. You'll enter the plant's details next.

Dendrobium


Dendrobium Berry Oda


Dendrobium sp.

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Enter plant details

The plant name is optional.

The acquisition date and acquisition source are useful for collection history, but they can be left blank if unknown. Use the date picker for the acquisition date, if known.

Acquired on
Optional. The date you obtained the plant. Leave blank if unknown.



<

May 2025

>

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
28	29	30	1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Clear

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Add plant

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Add plant

Dendrobium Berry Oda

This plant will be recorded under this species / hybrid. A permanent Plant Tag (ID) will be created automatically after saving.

Plant name

Optional. A personal name to help you recognise this plant.

Acquired on

Optional. The date you obtained the plant. Leave blank if unknown.

12 / 05 / 2025

**Acquired from**

Optional. Where the plant came from (e.g. nursery, friend, swap).

Burnham Nurseries

Plant notes

Optional. Any additional notes about this plant.

Mail order

[← Back](#)[Add plant](#)

3. Save the plant and note the Plant Tag

When you save, OrchidApp automatically creates a permanent **Plant Tag**.

The Plant Tag is the plant's stable ID. It should not be changed or reused.

It is recommended that the physical plant label includes the Plant Tag.

OrchidApp Home Plants Reports Setup About/Help

Search by tag

Find

Plant added

Dendrobium Berry Oda

Plant Tag (permanent id)

HU2-5486**Acquired on**

12/05/2025

Source

Burnham Nurseries

Name

—

[Continue](#)

4. Understand the Plant Details page

The Plant Details page is the main working page for each plant.

It shows:

- the permanent Plant Tag
- current location
- acquisition details
- recent repotting information
- recent flowering information
- plant history
- available plant actions

OrchidApp

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Dendrobium Berry Oda

Plant details

Plant tag

HU2 - 5486

Edit

Location

—

Acquisition

Acquired 12/05/2025 from Burnham Nurseries

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

No events recorded yet.

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The Plant Details page works as follows:

- The **Edit** button changes basic plant details for corrections.
- The large action buttons add new history records.
- History cards show observations, moves, flowering and repotting in date order.
- The plant image opens the Photos page when tapped.

5. Add an observation

Use observations for ordinary notes about the plant, such as:

- feeding
- leaf condition
- root growth
- pests

- treatment notes
- watering notes
- general care comments

To add an observation:

6. Open the plant.
7. Choose **Add observation**.
8. Enter the observation date.
9. Type the notes.
10. Choose **Add observation**.

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Add Observation

Dendrobium Berry Oda
HU2 - 5486

Record something you've noticed about this plant.

Choose a quick action or add general notes below.

 Add photo

 Feed (growth)

 Feed (bloom)

Observation date

25 / 07 / 2025



Notes

Leaves firm|



Add Observation

Back

The observation appears in the plant history.

6. Add a photo observation

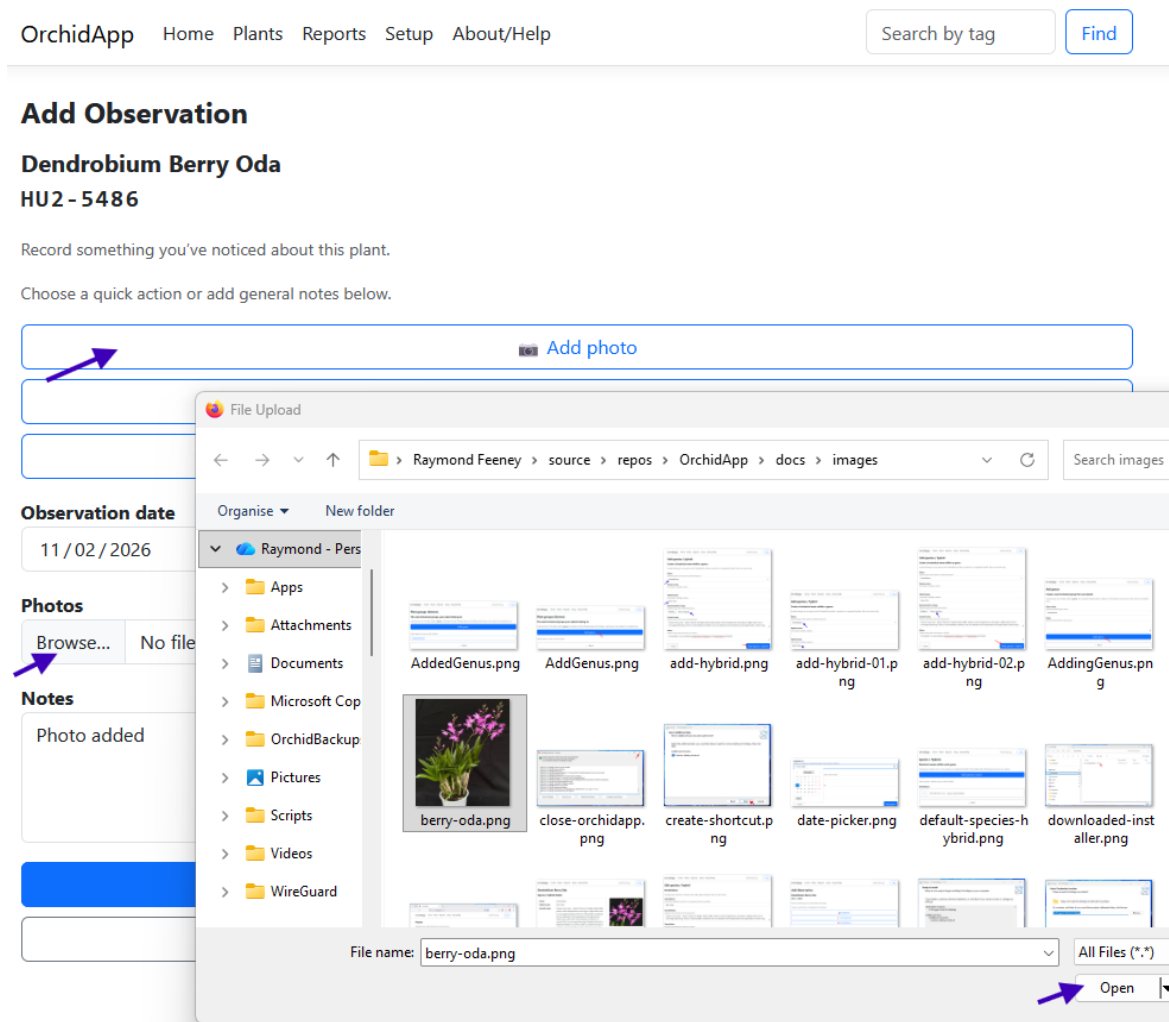
Photos are added through observations.

Use **Add photo** when the main purpose of the observation is to attach one or more plant photos.

To add a photo observation:

11. Open the plant.
12. Choose **Add observation**.
13. Choose **Add photo**.
14. Choose **Browse**.
15. Select the image file or files.
16. Save the observation.

The photo observation is added to the history.



7. Use the Photos page

Tap the plant image on the Plant Details page to open the Photos page.

The Photos page is for:

- browsing all plant photos
- uploading more photos
- choosing the main image for the plant

Dendrobium Berry Oda

Plant details

Plant tag HU2 - 5486 [Edit](#)

Location —

Acquisition Acquired 12/05/2025 from Burnham Nurseries



Tap image to view photos

History

[Add observation](#)[Move plant](#)[Add flowering](#)[Add repotting](#)

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

[Split plant](#)[Propagate plant](#)

[Observation](#) 11/02/2026

Photo added

[Edit event](#)[Remove event](#)

[Observation](#) 25/07/2025

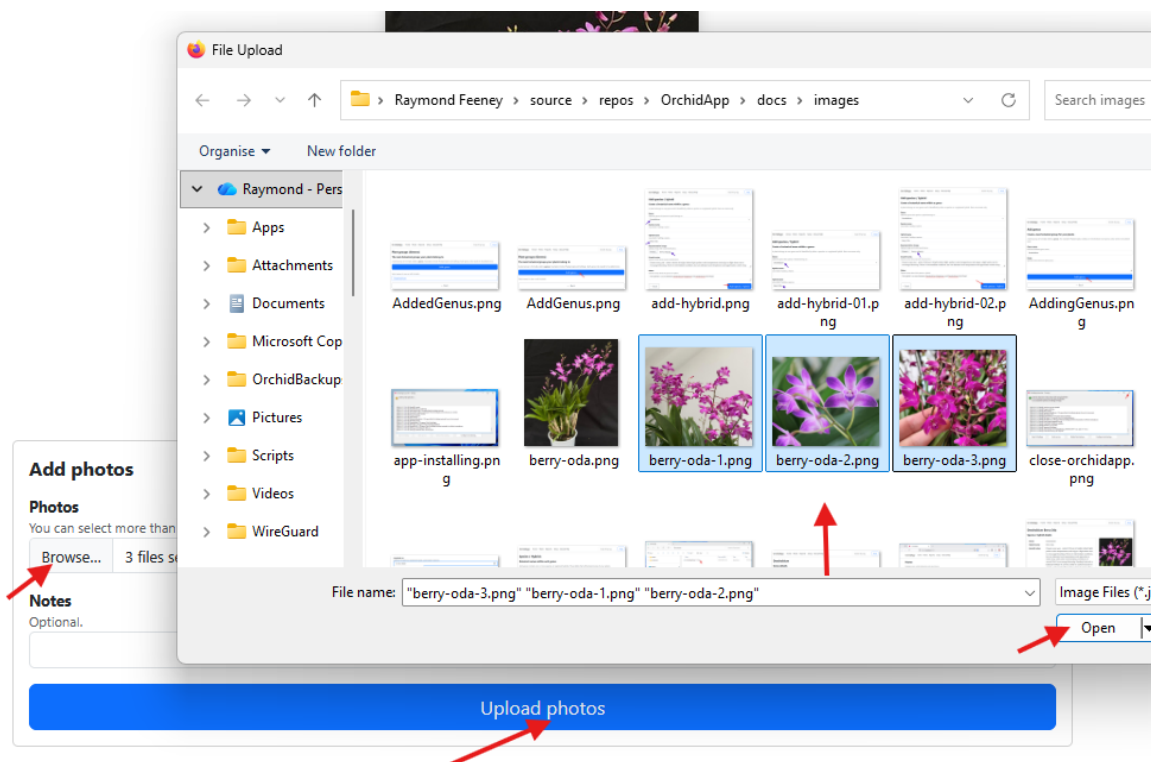
Leaves firm

[Edit event](#)[Remove event](#)

8. Upload more photos and set the main image

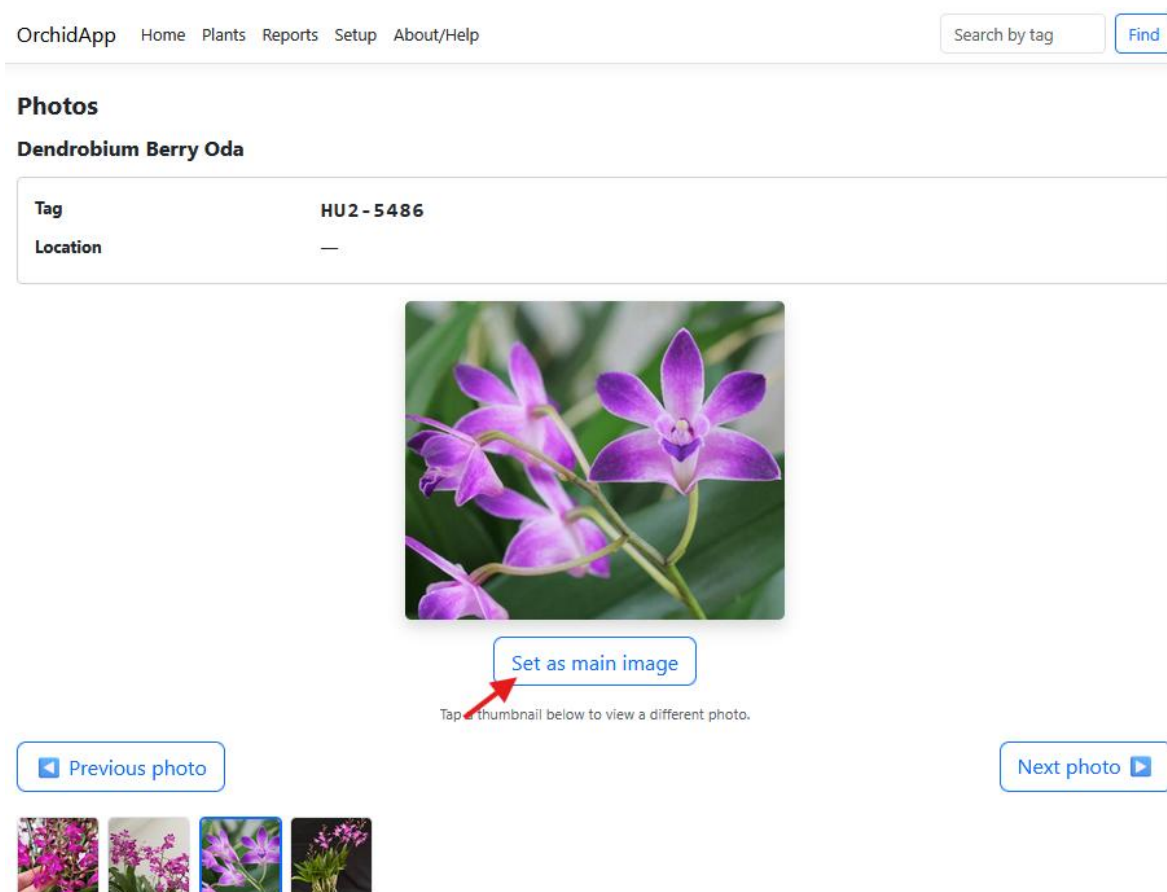
On the Photos page, you can upload more than one image at a time.

Select the files, choose **Open**, then upload them.



When viewing a photo that is not currently the main image, choose **Set as main image**.

The Plant Details page then shows the selected photo as the plant image.



9. Move a plant

Use **Move plant** when the plant changes growing location.

This updates the current location and preserves previous locations in the plant history.

To move a plant:

17. Choose **Move plant** on the Plant Details page.
18. Select the new location.
19. Enter the move date.
20. Add a move reason or location notes, if useful.
21. Choose **Move plant**.

The current location is shown in the plant summary.

10. Add flowering

Use **Add flowering** to record when a plant flowers.

Leave the end date blank if the plant is still flowering.

Flowering fields include:

- **Start date** — when flowering began
- **End date** — optional, and can be added later
- **Spike count** — useful for comparing future flowering
- **Flower count** — useful for comparing future flowering
- **Notes** — anything useful about the flowering

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Add Flowering

Dendrobium Berry Oda
HU2 - 5486

Record a flowering period for this plant.

Start date
Date flowering began.

28 / 07 / 2025

End date (optional)

dd / mm / yyyy

Leave blank if currently flowering.

Spike count

1

Flower count

4

Notes

Add Flowering

Back

Flowering appears in the history and summary.

11. Edit flowering when it ends

If you left the end date blank, use **Edit event** on the flowering history card when flowering has finished. Add the end date and save.

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Dendrobium Berry Oda

Plant details

Plant tag

HU2 - 5486

Edit

Location

Garden

Acquisition

Acquired 12/05/2025 from Burnham Nurseries

Flowering

Last flowered 28/07/2025



Tap image to view photos

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Observation

25/05/2026

Photo added

Edit event

Remove event

Observation

11/02/2026

Photo added

Edit event

Remove event

Flowering

28/07/2025

Flowered FROM 28-07-2025 (currently flowering) with 4 flowers over 1 spike

Edit event

Remove event

The flowering history updates after editing.

Edit flowering

Dendrobium Berry Oda

HU2 - 5486

Update this flowering record.

Flowering started on

28 / 07 / 2025

Flowering ended on

10 / 09 / 2025

12. Add repotting

Use **Add repotting** to record potting changes, medium condition and the reason for repotting.

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This helps build a useful care history.

Repotting fields include:

- **Previous growing medium** — what the plant was in before repotting
- **Condition notes** — root, pot or medium condition
- **New growing medium** — what the plant was repotted into
- **Reason for repotting** — why the change was made

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Add Repotting

Dendrobium Berry Oda
HU2-5486

Record when this plant was repotted and the growing medium used. Repotting history helps track root health and understand how long a plant has been in its current medium.

Repotting date
The date the plant was repotted.
 

Previous growing medium
Medium
The medium the plant was growing in before repotting.
 

Condition notes
Optional notes such as broken down bark, compacted moss, or root condition.
 

New pot and medium
New growing medium
The medium used after repotting.
 

Medium notes
Optional details such as bark size, moss mix, or additives used.
 

Pot size
The pot size used after repotting (e.g. 9 cm, 4 inch).

Reason for repotting
Optional. For example: medium breaking down, roots overcrowded, or moving to a larger pot.
 

Additional notes
Any other observations during repotting such as root condition or pests.
 



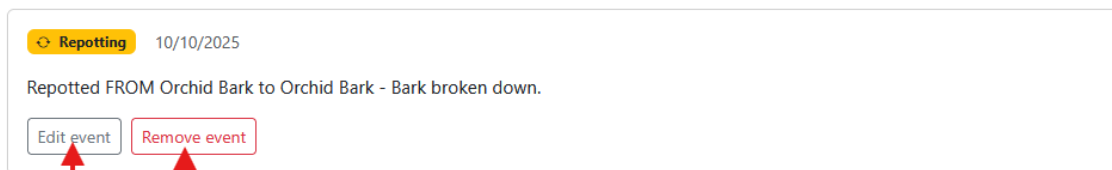
The repotting record appears in the history and updates the summary.

13. Edit or remove history events

Each history card has **Edit event** and **Remove event** buttons where the event type allows changes.

Use these to correct mistakes rather than creating duplicate records.

Use **Remove event** carefully.



For ordinary corrections, editing the existing event is usually better than removing it and adding a new one.

14. Split or propagate a plant

Split and propagation are more advanced than ordinary history events.

They both create new plant records, but they mean different things.

Split plant

Use **Split plant** when the original plant is ending and becoming two or more new independent plants.

The original plant becomes ended/read-only.

The new plants receive their own permanent Plant Tags and independent histories.

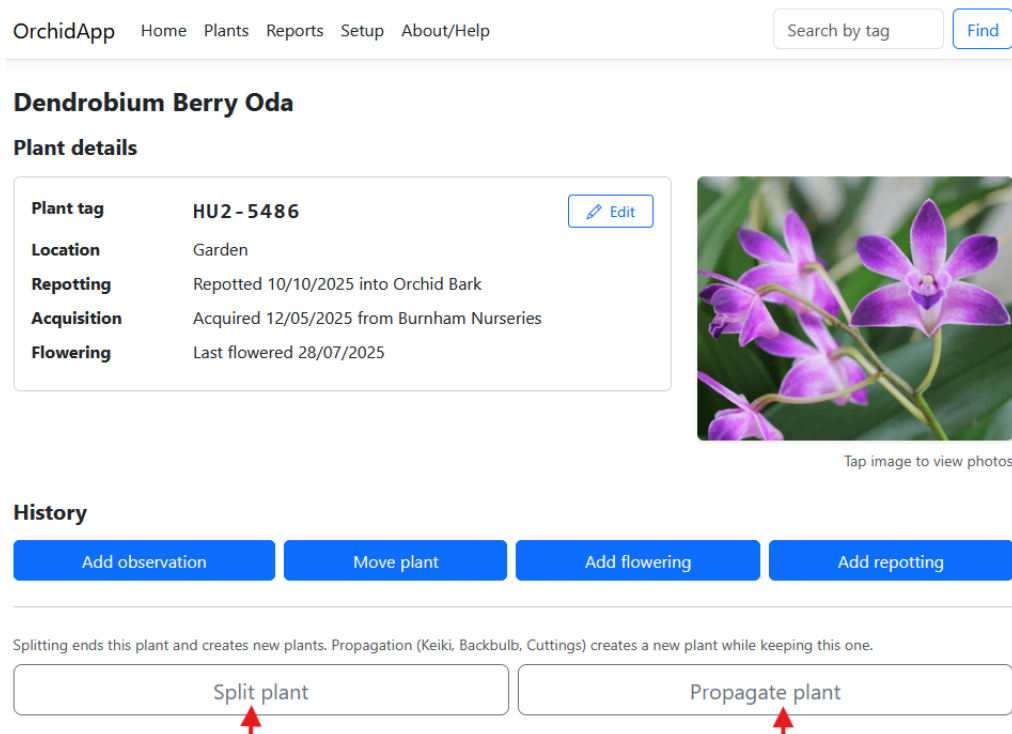
Propagate plant

Use **Propagate plant** when creating a new plant while keeping the original plant active.

Use it for propagation such as:

- keiki
- backbulb
- cutting

The new plant is linked to the original plant as provenance.



15. Split a plant

Splitting is permanent.

OrchidApp warns that the original plant will end and new plants will be created.

Enter:

- split date
- reason
- notes
- details for each new plant

Confirm the split only when you are sure.

The screenshot shows the 'Split a plant' form in OrchidApp. At the top, a note states: 'New plants will be given permanent IDs automatically.' The form includes sections for 'Split date' (06/01/2026), 'Reason for split' (Crowded roots), and 'Split notes'. Below these is the 'New plants' section, which contains two plant entry forms. A modal dialog box is overlaid on the first plant entry, displaying the URL 'localhost:5285' and a warning: 'You are about to end plant HU2-5486 on 25/05/2026 and create 2 new plant(s). This action cannot be undone.' with 'OK' and 'Cancel' buttons. A red arrow points to the 'OK' button. At the bottom of the form, a green arrow points to the 'Add another new plant' button, and another green arrow points to a summary bar that reads: 'This will end plant HU2-5486 on 25/05/2026 and create 2 new plant(s). This action cannot be undone.' A red arrow points to the 'Confirm split (ends this plant)' button at the bottom right.

16. After a split

After the split, OrchidApp shows the new permanent IDs.

The original plant becomes ended and read-only.

The new child plants are linked back to the parent through heritage.

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Plant split completed

Dendrobium Berry Oda

The split has created the following new plants.

New plant 1 permanent ID

MI3-5390

New plant 2 permanent ID

B06-7558

Continue to first new plant

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Dendrobium Berry Oda

Plant details

Plant tag

MI3-5390

Edit

Location

—

Repotting

Repotted 06/01/2026 into Orchid Bark

Acquisition

Acquired 06/01/2026 from Split from HU2-5486

Heritage

† Parent (Split)

HU2-5486

Ended 06/01/2026

View full lineage

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Repotting

06/01/2026

Repotted into Orchid Bark - Initial medium from split

Edit event

Remove event

17. View plant heritage

When a plant has a parent or child relationship, the **Heritage** section appears on the Plant Details page.

Use it to move between related plants and view the full lineage.

A child plant has its own Plant Tag and its own independent history.

Dendrobium Berry Oda Ended

Plant details

This plant has ended and is read-only.

Plant tag	HU2 - 5486	View details
Location	Garden	
Repotting	Repotted 10/10/2025 into Orchid Bark	
Acquisition	Acquired 12/05/2025 from Burnham Nurseries	
Flowering	Last flowered 28/07/2025	



Tap image to view photos

Heritage

↓ Child (Split)	MI3 - 5390 Created 06/01/2026
↓ Child (Split)	B06 - 7558 Created 06/01/2026

[View full lineage](#)

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Dendrobium Berry Oda

Lineage

B06 - 7558

Split date: 06/01/2026

MI3 - 5390
B06 - 7558

HU2 - 5486

Acquired date: 12/05/2025

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Plant management checklist

- Create the genus and species / hybrid before adding the plant.
- Use **Add plant** for each individual plant in the collection.
- Record ordinary care notes as observations.
- Add photos through observations or the Photos page.
- Use **Move plant** for location changes.
- Use **Add flowering** and **Add repotting** for structured care history.
- Use **Split plant** only when the original plant ends.
- Use **Propagate plant** when the original plant stays active.
- Use the Plant Tag to find and identify the plant later.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Do not create a new plant just because it moved location.
- Do not create a new plant just because it was repotted.

- Do not split a plant unless the original plant is ending.
- Do not rely on memory for plant identity: use the Plant Tag.

Getting support

If OrchidApp does not behave as expected, email:

OrchidApp@proton.me

When asking for help, include:

- what you were trying to do
- what happened
- any message shown by OrchidApp
- the plant name or Plant Tag, if the problem relates to a specific plant

For Linux/Pi installs, support may ask for the OrchidApp service log from the Raspberry Pi.

Guide complete

You can now use OrchidApp to add plants and build each plant's history over time.